NIHR | National Institute for Health and Care Research

Summary

Reference Number	33955
Lead Applicant	Mrs Tahrina Haque
Research Title	Pre-doctoral Fellowship Round 6
Total Research Cost	140,478.00

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Our purpose for collecting this data is to communicate with you about your application and have the necessary information to evaluate you for a grant. The data we collect here is collected in the public interest. Information provided here may be subject to Freedom of Information requests.

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1. Application Summary Information

Host organisation (which will administer any award)
Queen Mary University of London

Partner organisation (If applicable)	

Application Type	Mixed methods

Proposed start date if grant awarded	01/09/2024

Do you wish to hold a Pre-doctoral Fellowship for the full time equivalent of 12, 18 or 24 months?
24

Whole Time Equivalent (WTE) %
1.00

Duration The duration for your award is calculated automatically based on your chosen number of months you wish to hold the Pre-doctoral Fellowship, and your chosen WTE%.
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2. Applicant CV

A CV for the Applicant is a mandatory component of this application; please ensure this is completed fully.
Please note that some of the CV questions are automatically completed from information you have provided in the 'Update CV' section of the 'Manage My Details' page. These can be updated via the ARAMIS Home Page or by following this link https://aramis.nihr.ac.uk/MyAccount/UpdateCV.aspx

Degrees and Professional Qualifications

From	To	Qualification	Subject	Country	Institution	Class	Department
04/2013	12/2017	BSc(Hons)	Pharmacy		East West University, Dhaka, Bangladesh	First class honours	Pharmacy

Present and previous positions
(including from/to dates, job title and employer)

From	To	Position	Organisation	WTE % Research
02/2023	-	Community Engagement Research Assistant	Queen Mary University of London	100
05/2021	-	Clinical Coordinator	Barts Health NHS Trust	40
11/2019	04/2021	Bilingual Research Assistant	Queen Mary University of London	100

Research Grants held

Publication Record
This should display the authors, date, article title and journal name for each publication added.
This information can be edited via the “My Research Outputs” page of your ARAMIS account.

Publications
Huxford, B., **Haque, T.**, Joseph, AB., Simonet, C., Gallagher, D., Budu, C., Dobson, R. and Noyce, A.. (2021) ‘Parkinson's Disease and Type 2 Diabetes: HbA1c Is Associated with Motor and Cognitive Severity.’, *Movement disorders : official journal of the Movement Disorder Society*, 37(2).
Simonet, C., Galmes, MA., Lambert, C., Rees, RN., **Haque, T.**, Bestwick, JP., Lees, AJ., Schrag, A. and Noyce, AJ.. (2021) ‘Slow Motion Analysis of Repetitive Tapping (SMART) Test: Measuring Bradykinesia in Recently Diagnosed Parkinson's Disease and Idiopathic Anosmia.’, *Journal of Parkinson's disease*, 11(4).

Relevant Prizes, Awards and other Academic Distinctions

Date (mm/yyyy)	Source	Prize	Role of Applicant

ORCID iD 0009-0005-6462-3287

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3. Applicant Research Background

Professional Background	Not a Registered Health or Care Professional

Profession (Not a Registered Health or Care Professional)
Other

If 'Other' Profession (Not a Registered Health or Care Professional) please specify
Researcher

Please describe your research career to date

I am an early career researcher, with exposure to qualitative, quantitative, and mixed methods research. The NIHR pre-doctoral fellowship is a prime opportunity to advance my career as a mixed methods researcher. I am committed to a future career in mixed methods research.

Education

I pursued a Pharmacy (BSc) degree (2013-2017) at East West University in Dhaka, Bangladesh. I achieved first-class honours, and a significant part of this success was attributed to my final year research project. I completed a 10,000-word dissertation titled 'A survey on knowledge of osteoporosis among female teachers in Bangladesh'. I employed a sequential explanatory mixed-methods design combining surveys and semi-structured interviews. Data was collected from two cities, Rajshahi and Sylhet, in Bangladesh. Quantitative data was analysed using descriptive statistics (mean, median and standard deviation), to summarise and describe participants' knowledge scores on osteoporosis. Comparative analysis (t-test and chi-test) was used to explore differences in knowledge levels based on demographic variables. Qualitative data, analysed through thematic analysis, provided deeper understanding and context, to my empirical results. I have completed & submitted the ethics application to the Faculty of Pharmacy Ethics Committee for approval. During my final year I completed a short module on statistics and qualitative and quantitative research methods.

Voluntary Experience

Community Researcher

In 2019, I volunteered for Social Action for Health, a community-based health charity supporting those most affected by health inequalities. I volunteered as a lead community researcher on their cancer awareness project. My activities aimed to increase awareness; earlier medical interventions; and attendance at routine cancer screenings amongst the British Bangladeshi community in Tower Hamlets, London.

I engaged members of the public through visits to libraries, community centres, and mosques. I conducted a face-to-face survey using the Cancer Awareness Measure (CAM) questionnaire. CAM explores factors contributing to inadequate awareness and aims to develop interventions to promote awareness among ethnic minority communities in East London.

Employment

Bilingual Research Assistant

From November 2019, I worked as a Bilingual Research Assistant at Queen Mary University of London (QMUL) on the East London Parkinson's Disease (ELPD) project, funded by the Michael J. Fox Foundation. The project, led by Professor Alastair Noyce, is a platform study for under-represented patients with Parkinson's disease in East London.

I created a register of 500 Parkinson's disease patients at The Royal London Hospital. Creation of the register involved data management and analysis. This involved data cleaning, fixing inconsistencies, secure data storage,

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and preparing data for data archiving. I followed Open Science principles and practices to enhance reproducibility.

I recruited approximately 200 new participants to the study. I handled various research tasks, including qualitative and quantitative data collection, statistical data analysis including linear and non-linear regression models, report writing, and project management duties. I worked closely with community members to co-develop culturally appropriate research protocols and interventions. I gained an appreciation of ethical considerations in research.

Clinical Coordinator

From 2021, I worked as a Clinical Coordinator at Barts Health NHS Trust. My role was funded by Parkinson's UK. A significant component of my role was to continue research on the ELPD project.

As a lead applicant, I applied for and was awarded £500 (2021) and £700 (2022) grant to raise Parkinson's disease awareness in Tower Hamlets. I engaged over 2,000 people through engagement activities, such as the Festival of Communities at QMUL and visits to local mosques and parks. I developed educational materials for patients and their caregivers, conducted quarterly educational sessions, and organised PPIE. The primary focus of the PPIE was to foster collaboration between researchers and participants, ensuring that the research aligns with the need and priorities of those directly impacted by it.

Through my clinical coordinator role, I have gained insights into care provision for Parkinson's disease patients. For example, diagnostic and treatment pathways, what routine care looks like, and patient and healthcare provider experiences.

Community Engagement Research Assistant

Since February 2023, I have been working as a Community Engagement Research Assistant on the Mapping Practices of Participation project, led by Dr Megan Clinch at QMUL and funded by Research England. The project explores participation through evaluating co-production and Patient Public Involvement and Engagement (PPIE) activities across the Faculty of Medicine and Dentistry at QMUL.

I have conducted a literature review and thematically analysed content from 43 studies using Braun and Clarke's method. I have also drafted interview questions for academics, community organisations, and members of the public. I have conducted 20 semi-structured interviews, and am using NVivo software to sort, code, and organise the data.

Fellowship Suitability

My years of experience in academic and community settings, positions me as an excellent candidate for the NIHR Pre-doctoral Fellowship. Through projects like the ELPD study, I have contributed to the local community in East London, while 'Mapping Practices of Participation' offers the promise of influencing future participation practices. These experiences along with my undergraduate dissertation have provided me with a solid foundation in qualitative, quantitative, and mixed methods research. Particularly, It has developed my interest in mixed methodology. I believe that the integration of qualitative and quantitative research approaches provides a more comprehensive and nuanced understanding of complex and multifaceted health and social care issues. Especially in under-served communities. The NIHR Pre-doctoral Fellowship presents an opportunity to develop my skills in mixed methods research and accelerate my research career.

I am committed to joining the NIHR Academy due to the NIHR's strategic focus on research for under-served communities (e.g. NIHR-INCLUDE project) and embedding equality, diversity, and inclusion (EDI) across NIHR's research, systems, and culture. Through my research experiences I aimed to promote research in and with under-served communities and PPIE. I am committed to research directly benefitting patients, carers, and the public.

This fellowship will provide strong theoretical underpinnings to my practical experiences in research methodologies. This fellowship, coupled with my "hands on" experiences, will provide a solid basis to undertake a future PhD in mixed methods research. Upon completing this fellowship, I aim to undertake an NIHR Doctoral Fellowship and ultimately pursue a career as a mixed methods researcher.

Has this application, or a similar application, previously been submitted to this or any other funding body?
No

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Contextual Factors

Please use this question to detail any contextual factors you wish to make the funding Committee aware of. NIHR wants to know about any circumstances so that they may take them into consideration during the assessment of your application. Contextual factors may include:

- Career breaks due to parental leave, or periods of illness.
- Reduced time spent undertaking research due to a disability or caring responsibilities. This could include any physical or mental difficulty that may have impacted your research career. These are situations that have a significant impact on your ability to undertake research.
- Reduced opportunities to career support e.g. mentorship, and limited opportunities to undertake prior research and training.
- Impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on your research career.

Please also use this section to detail any other factors that may have impacted your research career not listed in the examples provided. The impact on your career to date will be specific to your particular circumstances but could include such impacts as limited opportunities to obtain grant funding, or fewer publications. In general terms, mitigating factors should be significant, and relevant.

NIHR acknowledges that you may be reluctant, or uncomfortable disclosing relevant information that is sensitive. However, you should bear in mind that we are unable to take into account factors that you do not disclose. Please be assured that information provided by you is sensitive and will be treated confidentially and in line with General Data and Protection Regulations (GDPR).

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4. Training & Development and Research Support

Proposed training and development programme

I plan to pursue an MSc in Social Research Methods at University College London (UCL) and work concurrently as a Research Assistant at QMUL. I believe that concurrently being a researcher and a student is the most practical approach, allowing me to continue learning while actively applying my skills in meaningful research endeavours. These dual roles will complement each other, providing me with transferable skills to excel in both capacities under expert supervision.

The MSc Social Research Methods is a broad master's level training programme. It will provide high quality instruction in the twin pillars of mixed methodology research, quantitative and qualitative methods. This MSc is designed to develop researchers and provide them with relevant methodological theory and experience.

Year 1

- Introduction to Qualitative Methods [term 1]
- Introduction to Regression Analysis [term 1]
- Survey Design [term 1]
- Advanced Qualitative Methods [term 2]
- Advanced Quantitative Methods [term 2]
- Ethnography [term 2]

Year 2

- Systematic Review Design and Planning [term 1]
- Research Engagement, Participation, and Impact [term 1]

Years 1 & 2

- Dissertation [60 credits]

Additional Training

Mixed Methods Course

- Mixed Methods in Health Research, University of Oxford [7 weeks online, 1 week in-person]

This is a comprehensive course focusing on the practical ways to combine qualitative and quantitative methodologies. I will learn how to design, implement, and analyse mixed methods studies within health and social care research contexts. This programme provides essential preparation for my fellowship and subsequent PhD.

Patient Public Involvement & Engagement

I have chosen an expansive course due to the participatory nature of my proposed research.

- Participatory Approaches in Public Health Specialisation, Imperial College London [60 hours, online]
- PPIE training offered by the NIHR
- Bespoke PPIE training offered by Centre for Public Engagement, QMUL

Academic & Research Skills

I will undertake a comprehensive programme of short courses and bespoke support offered by the Centre for Academic and Professional Development, and Joint Research Management Office, QMUL:

- Research Integrity Training at the beginning of my fellowship.
- Early Career Researcher writing retreat.
- Research Management.

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Research (QMUL)

My proposed research has been shaped by my previous experience and learnings. Working on the East London Parkinson's Disease (ELPD) project, fostered a desire to continuing working on Parkinson's disease and exploring the impact on the lives of people living with the condition. My work on the 'Mapping Practices of Participation' project and with under-served communities has informed the participatory approach I plan to take. The NIHR's strategic focus on patient benefit, involvement, and inclusivity underlines my proposed research.

I plan to research the treatment priorities of under-served communities living with Parkinson's disease in East London. This will be multi-staged mixed-methods research following James Lind Alliance (JLA) Priority Settings Partnership (PSP) methods.

The NIHR funds the infrastructure of the JLA to oversee the processes for PSPs. PSPs aim to help patients, carers and clinicians work together to agree which are the most important evidence uncertainties affecting their particular interest, in order to influence the prioritisation of future research in that area [https://www.jla.nihr.ac.uk/about-the-james-lind-alliance/about-psps.htm].

PSPs have previously been outlined in Parkinson's. However, these priorities have been heavily influenced by white middle-class groups, with limited responses from ethnic minorities. Since ethnicity is known to influence epidemiology, clinical manifestation, and the clinical pathway of Parkinson's disease, my research will aim to capture the voices of ethnically diverse groups in relation to Parkinson's disease research priorities.

The research includes:

Stage 1: Forming a steering group with diverse stakeholders to define the priority setting scope, develop a study protocol, and oversee the process. Potential steering group members have already been identified through the ELPD study.

Stage 2: Scoping review of existing literature. Developing a survey based on steering group feedback. Administering this to various stakeholders through multiple channels, seeking input on research questions related to Parkinson's and diverse ethnic communities.

Stage 3: Collate and qualitatively analyse survey responses using thematic analysis. Group recurring themes into a long list of summary questions, involving a team of researchers.

Stage 4: Verify summary questions against the literature review to ensure they represent true uncertainties.

Stage 5: Developing and administering a second survey, asking stakeholders to rank the list of summary questions.

Stage 6: Quantitatively analyse responses to produce a top-ranked list. Host a workshop with diverse stakeholders to finalize the 'Top 10' priorities using consensus methods, co-facilitated by a PPIE expert from Centre for Public Engagement, QMUL.

The proposed research has a data validation stage, where the results of the scoping review validate the initial survey data. An exploratory sequential mixed method stage, where the findings of the qualitative stages determine second survey, quantitative data collection, and subsequent quantitative data analysis. An explanatory sequential mixed method stage, where the findings of the quantitative stage are refined by the stakeholder workshop, a qualitative research method. My proposed research will provide a framework for high quality research experience of a mixed methods study.

During my subsequent PhD, I will continue to publish and promote the 'Top 10' list of priorities and conduct research focusing on addressing the questions highlighted by stakeholders.

Ethics: An amendment will be submitted to our existing approved ethics application for ELPD. To minimise delays, the amendment and accompanying study documents will be submitted prior to the fellowship to ensure this starts on time.

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Conferences

I will submit my research findings to the largest international conference for Parkinson's research and 2 NIHR conferences tailored to my career stage:

- NIHR Academy Members' Conference (2025)
- Annual Conference, NIHR School for Social Care Research (2025 & 2026)
- International Congress of Parkinson's Disease and Movement Disorders, Movement Disorder Society (MDS) (2026)

Overall Expected Outcomes

- To gain a thorough understanding of mixed methods research
- To develop practical experience and specialist knowledge of undertaking a mixed methods research project
- To build strong foundations for a future research career
- To grow as a researcher, specialising in participatory and mixed methods research, in health and social care
- To prepare for an NIHR Doctoral Fellowship
- In January 2026, start preparing for NIHR Doctoral Fellowship application, for submission by July 2026.

As your supervisors will play an active role in supporting you throughout the duration of the fellowship, it is a mandatory requirement that at least one of the supervisors has the necessary experience and expertise within your chosen methodology. Please also ensure that each supervisor documents the number of students they have supervised to completion, and the number of students they are currently supervising.

Primary Academic Supervisor

PRIMARY ACADEMIC SUPERVISOR 1

Name	Laura Smith

Institution	Queen Mary University of London

Position	Lecturer in Health Psychology

Description of support provided
Dr Laura Smith will be my primary academic and research supervisor. She will support and train me throughout the fellowship. Dr Smith is a Lecturer in Health Psychology at the Centre for Preventive Neurology, Wolfson Institute for Population Health (WIPH), Queen Mary University of London (QMUL). Dr Smith is a mixed methods researcher with expertise in neuropsychology, health psychology, and behavioural science. Her research topics include comprehensive care for Parkinson's Disease, cognitive problems in multiple sclerosis, and psychological aspects of vestibular disorders. Her research uses a variety of approaches including electrophysiological recordings of brain activity, qualitative analysis, behavioural assessments, and cognitive interventions. She has conducted and published multiple mixed methods projects which integrate qualitative and quantitative data. These include a multi-centre randomised controlled trial combining self-report questionnaires alongside interviews and a process evaluation; a multi-centre observational study combining self-report questionnaires alongside interviews and an intervention fidelity evaluation; and multiple online surveys which simultaneously capture closed and open responses. Of particular relevance to my application, she has expertise in thematic analysis, analysing quantitative survey data, and integrating these comments. Dr Smith currently supervises two MSc students. To date, she has supervised three research assistants and two visiting international researchers to complete mixed-methods projects. Previously she also supervised nine MSc, twelve BSc, and two placement students to conduct their dissertation projects. Dr Smith has second supervised

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three PhD students.

She was elected to the Executive Committee of the British Neuropsychological Society, is a trustee for multiple charities, and leads multiple early career initiatives within the Wolfson Institute of Population Health (WIPH). Dr Smith is therefore well placed to support my development and collaborative working.

Dr Smith has already supported me throughout my NIHR application preparation. Our current working relationship and modes of communication will readily translate to that of a student-supervisor relationship. This fellowship will be hosted by Centre for Preventive Neurology (CPN), WIPH where I will have access to support, direction, and advice from Dr Smith on a weekly basis. I will also schedule monthly meetings with her and Professor Alastair Noyce to review my progress with the pre-doctoral fellowship training programme and Doctoral fellowship application.

Supervisory expectations have already been discussed. Dr Smith is committed to my future career as a mixed methods researcher. Dr Smith will provide primary support, advice, and guidance on all aspects of my proposed research. We have begun to prepare a reading list and resources relating to mixed-methods research. As this MSc is a building block to my long-term career, Dr Smith will provide pastoral and career development support. We will work together to prioritise opportunities for further development.

Secondary Supervisor

SECONDARY SUPERVISOR 1

Name	Alastair Noyce

Institution	Queen Mary University of London

Position	Professor in Neurology and Neuroepidemiology

Description of support provided

Professor Alastair Noyce is the deputy lead within the Centre for Preventive Neurology (CPN), WIPH, QMUL. He is a Consultant Neurologist at the Barts Health NHS Trust.

Professor Noyce's research interests are Parkinson's disease and other neurodegenerative disorders. Professor Noyce is Co-Principal Investigator of the PREDICT-PD study, Principal Investigator for the ELPD project, and Chief Investigator for the Access-PD study. He is a member of the International Parkinson's and Movement Disorder Society (MDS). His roles in the MDS are chair of the epidemiology study group, member of the early onset PD study, member of the equality of access to care committee, and faculty for the LEAP leadership course. He is on the steering committee of the Global Parkinson's Genetics Program (GP2), and he leads training and networking, and the prodromal work packages.

Professor Alastair Noyce has extensive supervision experience, currently 5 PhD students (1 MD, 1 PhD completed), 1 MSc student (12 completed), and several postdocs and clinical academic trainees (45 supervisees in total). He has extensive experience in quantitative methodology and will provide advice and guidance on the quantitative aspects of my research.

I started at QMUL as a Bilingual Research Assistant, under the supervision of Professor Alastair Noyce, over 4 years ago. He has continuously supported me throughout my career as a researcher, providing an enriching learning environment and being a great mentor during my career to date. Professor Noyce has established local, national, and international links, networks, and collaborations. This will provide unique opportunities to gain further experiences in the future.

Professor Noyce will be my secondary supervisor and I will meet him monthly to review my progress with the fellowship. I will also attend monthly ELPD meetings and receive support from the wider team, formed of doctors,

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post-doctoral, PhD, and dissertation students. I have been supported by Professor Noyce with advice and guidance, and identifying how the networks and resources of the ELPD project and the Centre for Preventive Neurology can be utilised for my proposed research.

Research Support/Supervisor

RESEARCH SUPPORT / SUPERVISOR 1

Name	Ratna Sohanpal

Institution	Queen Mary University of London

Position	Health Services Researcher

Description of support provided

Dr Ratna Sohanpal is an NIHR School for Primary Care (SPCR) fellow. She works as a health services researcher based in the Centre for Primary Care, Wolfson Institute of Population Health, Queen Mary University of London.

Dr Sohanpal has extensive experience on qualitative and mixed methods research. She will oversight and give direction on the qualitative and mixed methods elements of my proposed research. Currently, Dr Sohanpal supervises one PhD student. She has experience of supervising researchers conducting Mixed methods research.

Dr Sohanpal is leading on two NIHR SPCR studies:

- Assessing and understanding the potential of assistive technology in people with chronic obstructive pulmonary disease to support independence and wellbeing: A mixed-methods study.
- Exploring the problem of Inclusivity and Identifying solutions in REMOTE CARE delivery in people with chronic obstructive pulmonary disease and multimorbidity (COPD&MM) from minoritised ethnic groups, their carer, and professional interpreters (INCLUSIVE REMOTE CARE): a qualitative study.

Previously she was involved in a NIHR SPCR funded study called REMO CARE which explored the potential opportunities and challenges in Remote CARE for chronic obstructive pulmonary disease.

She was also involved in NIHR CTU support funded study called INCLUDED (Promoting Inclusivity through improving the practice and utility of Ethnicity Data collection in trials). The aim of the INCLUDED study is to provide initial guidance for researchers to improve the collection of ethnicity data in UK clinical trials.

I believe that Dr Sohanpal will be an excellent research supervisor and provide relevant support and advice throughout my Pre-doctoral fellowship.

Collaborations

The NIHR Pre-doctoral Fellowship will enable me to pursue an MSc concurrently with my role as a research assistant at the Centre for Preventive Neurology, Wolfson Institute of Population Health (WIPH), Queen Mary University of London (QMUL). Utilising my existing collaborations, particularly my involvement in the East London Parkinson's Disease project led by Professor Alastair Noyce since 2019, I have established a partnership between Bangabandhu Sheikh Mujib Medical University (BSMMU) in Dhaka, Bangladesh, and QMUL. The joint initiative, the 'London-Dhaka Parkinson’s Disease Cognition Study,' funded by the Michael J Fox Foundation, seeks to comprehend Parkinson's disease prevalence, cognitive impairments, and treatment priorities in Bangladesh.

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I will spend two weeks in Dhaka, engaging with Parkinson's disease patients, caregivers, and health professionals at BSMMU. This visit will afford me valuable insights into the research and treatment priorities of Bangladeshi Parkinson's disease patients. Additionally, I plan to conduct a Public and Patient Involvement and Engagement (PPIE) exercise to gather perspectives from Parkinson's disease patients, caregivers, and healthcare professionals, building upon the positive relationships already established with the research team in Dhaka. I anticipate that this experience will not only enhance my proposed research but also contribute positively to under-served communities in East London.

Furthermore, I will collaborate with Dr Katie Brittain, Professor of Applied Health Research & Ageing in the Population Health Sciences Institute at Newcastle University. Facilitated by Professor Alastair Noyce, this collaboration will involve a two-week shadowing experience with Dr Brittain's team, focusing on mixed-methods Parkinson's disease projects aimed at under-served communities. This endeavour is expected to strengthen my proficiency in mixed methods research.

In parallel, I plan to seize the opportunity to shadow mixed methods research within the Wolfson Institute of Population Health at QMUL during my pre-doctoral fellowship. These collaborations are anticipated to serve as a platform for knowledge exchange activities, contributing not only to the enhancement of my skill set but also aligning seamlessly with my overarching research objectives. I am confident that this fellowship will represent a transformative chapter, allowing me to integrate knowledge, skills, and collaborative efforts to conduct meaningful research in under-served communities.

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Host Organisation Support Statement

The Head of department of the employing host organisation will be able to add the statement of support to the form once they have confirmed participation. Invitations to participate are sent by the applicant via the 'Participants and Signatories' section of the form.

Statement of support

As Director of the Wolfson Institute of Population Health (WIPH), I am delighted to offer this supporting statement for Tahrina Haque's application for an NIHR Pre-Doctoral Fellowship to be held at the Centre for Preventive Neurology (CPN), within the WIPH.

Tahrina Haque first joined QMUL in November 2019 as a research assistant at the Preventive Neurology Unit (PNU), currently CPN. Since then, Ms. Haque has become a valuable member of the WIPH. She played a pivotal role in the East London Parkinson's Disease (ELPD) study. Ms. Haque has been featured in Parkinson's UK for her contribution to raising Parkinson's Disease awareness and increasing ethnic minority research participation in East London. She has made great connections within WIPH and has attended various academic skills programmes. Currently, Ms. Haque is working as a community engagement research assistant under Dr Megan Clinch in the Centre for Global Public Health, WIPH. Her fellowship will be overseen by Dr Laura Smith and Professor Alastair Noyce, deputy lead of the CPN.

CPN brings together an expert team to carry out revolutionary new research into dementia, multiple sclerosis, and Parkinson's disease. Their focus is on academic discipline, research, the translation of research into health strategies and their practical implementation – all dedicated to the reduction of disease and disability. The Unit was formed in 2017 following investment from Barts Charity and has grown rapidly within the Wolfson Institute. Substantial additional funding has been awarded from the NIHR, MRC, UK MS Society, Parkinson's UK, NMSS, Cure Parkinson's, BMA Foundation and the Aligning Science Across Parkinson's Initiative. The progress of the Unit achieving Centre status reflects its rapidly growing reputation and unique research portfolio. Its work across multiple neurological conditions, with a view to developing interventions underpinned by high quality evidence from diverse populations, is internationally unique.

People living with neurological disease are central to the work of the CPN, which is at the forefront of patient and public involvement and engagement (PPIE) in research. The Centre partners with community groups across East London and the UK to ensure that its research remains relevant to participants and works with a range of disciplines to explore novel PPIE methodology. The CPN prioritises inclusivity to ensure that diverse patient populations and communities are fully represented.

The WIPH has supported four NIHR pre-doctoral fellowships with start dates in the last four years. One of those has moved into a full-time research position in the Institute, another is now undertaking a PhD at Imperial, and two have taken jobs outside of academia on an interim basis and plan to build towards a PhD application.

Given the volume and breadth of early career researchers within the Institute, they have formed their own active Early Career Researcher Group, which Ms. Haque will also join. The ECR forum receives institute funding for bespoke training and/or expenses for invited external speakers. The institute provides other opportunities for shared experience and intellectual discussion with students and staff, including “Thinking between the lines” qualitative methods and critical theory group. There is also a further opportunity to present work to students and staff at the annual WIPH Graduate Studies Day. WIPH provides a rich research environment, offering a weekly seminar across the range of disciplines represented in the institute.

In addition to the opportunities within the CPN and WIPH, Ms. Haque will complete mandatory Epigeum Research Integrity Training at the beginning of her fellowship to ensure she is aware of the principles and responsibilities required of every researcher throughout the research process. She will also have the opportunity to acquire transferable skills throughout the Fellowship. Within QMUL, the Centre for Academic and Professional Development provides a comprehensive programme of short courses and bespoke support from which students from any Faculty may select an appropriate programme. These include generic writing and presentation skills, personal organisation, specific skills (e.g. using reference management software), career planning, and dealing with the media. Where appropriate formal transferable skill training is not available within Queen Mary, Ms. Haque will be supported to access appropriate training informally or elsewhere.

Queen Mary University of London offers an unparalleled environment within which to undertake this training. QMUL’s research outputs, impact performance and research environment were all highly competitive as assessed in the 2021 Research Excellence Framework. We were ranked 7th in the UK for quality.

Queen Mary is one of the most diverse, research-led universities in the world. Equality diversity and inclusion (EDI) principles are fully and actively embedded into all day-to-day and strategic decision-making within the Faculty of Medicine and Dentistry (FMD), alongside being reflected in our research aims (Every life is precious). This work is led by four academic staff, supported by two professional services staff, with a network of academic and professional services staff with recognised roles within each institute, leading change at all levels. The overarching mission is to create a truly inclusive environment, building on our cherished cultural diversity, where students and staff flourish, reach their full potential and are proud to be part of the University. EDI is embedded into all meeting structures, forums and policies and procedures within each of the six FMD institutes, including WIPH. Faculty and institute-level leadership committees contain EDI representation, and institute EDI reps ensure that faculty-level initiatives result in meaningful outcomes as well as developing and leading local change. This commitment to EDI is reflected by the faculty’s receipt of an ATHENA SWAN Gold Award in 2024.

In conclusion, the development of our early research staff is pivotal to the development of the research and training base of the University, the region, and the national research agenda. The University would be delighted to host this award on behalf of Tahrina Haque.

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5. Detailed Budget

The finance section should provide a breakdown of costs associated with undertaking the Fellowship as described in the proposal.

This section must be completed by the Applicant in conjunction with the Research Support Officer or Finance Officer at the host organisation.

STAFF DETAILS 1

Staff type	Lead Applicant

Name	Tahrina Haque

Employing organisation	Queen Mary University of London

Role on this research	Research Assistant

Grade	4 RES

Starting point on scale	033

Increment Date	01/08/2024

Justification of Costs
I propse to working as a Research Assistant at Queen Mary University of London and undertake a part-time MSc Social Research Methods at University College London.

Details of Posts and Salaries Costs

	Total (£)
Salary (£)	44926
Geographical Weighting (£)	0
Other allowances (£)	224
Superannuation (£)	6514
Nat. Insurance (£)	5553
Current Annual Costs (£)	**57217**

Direct Costs
These are the costs that are specific to the Fellowship, which will be charged as the amount actually spent and can be supported by an audit record.

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Staff Type: (Lead Applicant)-Mrs Tahrina Haque
Type of cost: Other
% Full-time on this research: 100.0
Total months on this research: 24.0
Justification of Cost: I propse to working as a Research Assistant at Queen Mary University of London and undertake a part-time MSc Social Research Methods at University College London.

	Year 1	Year 2	Total Cost (£)
Basic Salary	44927	47285	92212
National Insurance	5553	5918	11471
Superannuation	6514	6856	13370
Geographical weighting / Other allowances (if applicable)	667	708	1375

Travel, Subsistence and Conference Fees
No costs have been added

Training And Development

Type of cost: HEI
Description: Other
Item Description: MSc Social Research Methods
Justification of Cost: MSc course fee

	Year 1	Year 2	Total Cost (£)
	7550	7550	15100

Type of cost: HEI
Description: Other
Item Description: MSc Social Research Methods
Justification of Cost: Admission fee

	Year 1	Year 2	Total Cost (£)
	90	0	90

Type of cost: HEI
Description: Short Courses
Item Description: Mixed Methods in Health Research- University of Oxford
Justification of Cost: Course fee

	Year 1	Year 2	Total Cost (£)
	0	2900	2900

Type of cost: HEI
Description: Other
Item Description: Supervision
Justification of Cost: Allocated to supervisors

	Year 1	Year 2	Total Cost (£)
	500	500	1000

Type of cost: Other
Description: Conference Attendance
Item Description: Movement Disorders Congress 2026

Pre-submission

Justification of Cost: As per the guidance- £1000 can be claimed for conference fee. This cost includes conference fee, journey costs, accomodation and subsistence fee.

	Year 1	Year 2	Total Cost (£)
	0	1000	1000

Type of cost: Other
Description: Workshops
Item Description: Patient Public Invovement and Engagement (PPIE) and Workshop
Justification of Cost: My proposed research will involve PPIE activities. This cost is for PPIE members. I will have 2 PPIE members for each of my research stages and in workshop I will have 5 PPIE members. This cost includes reimbursement of their time, travel cost and refreshment.

	Year 1	Year 2	Total Cost (£)
	500	500	1000

Type of cost: Other
Description: Short Courses
Item Description: Mixed Methods in Health Research- University of Oxford
Justification of Cost: Subsistence (accomodation, food etc) costs for 7 nights in Oxford. The Wellington square in central Oxford is an accomodation for students doing short courses. The fee for a bedroom including meals is on average £120 per day.

	Year 1	Year 2	Total Cost (£)
	0	840	840

Type of cost: Other
Description: Short Courses
Item Description: Mixed Methods in Health Research- University of Oxford
Justification of Cost: Journey cost

	Year 1	Year 2	Total Cost (£)
	0	120	120

	Year 1	Year 2	Total Cost (£)
Training And Development Total	8640	13410	22050

Summary

	Year 1	Year 2	Total Cost (£)
Salaries	**57661**	**60767**	**118428**
Travel-subsistence-and-conference-fees	**0**	**0**	**0**
Training And Development	**8640**	**13410**	**22050**
Total	**66301**	**74177**	**140478**

Pre-submission

6. Uploads

Please upload a Gantt chart that shows when your training and development will take place during the proposed award timescale.

When uploading a document to your application, please ensure that it is in Adobe PDF or Word DOC/DOCX format. It is not possible to upload a JPEG image or Excel spreadsheet to your application; if you try to upload a JPEG or Excel file, it will not attach to your application.

(Training & Development Gantt Chart - Gantt Chart.pdf) is included as an appendix within this file.

Pre-submission

7. Participants and Signatories

The applicant is required to supply the names and email addresses (if not already registered on ARAMIS) of the individuals who will be undertaking **'Participant'** and **'Signatory'** roles as part of the application. Please note that it is acceptable for the 'Head of Department' signatory to also act in a supervisor role (Participant). If this is the case, they will need to be included in this section for both roles.

Once the applicant has supplied their details, Participants and Signatories will be asked to confirm their participation, and in doing so acknowledge their involvement and input into this application and agree to be involved in it.

Participation must be confirmed by all Participants and Signatories before the application is submitted.

You must ensure that all Participants and Signatories are happy for your application to be submitted before submitting it on the online system.

Signatories must also approve your application after you select the 'submit' option but BEFORE the application submission deadline.

Pre-submission

Primary Academic Supervisor

Primary Supervisor Participant (PF)

Title	Dr
Forename(s)	Laura
Surname	Smith
Position	Lecturer in Health Psychology

Secondary Supervisor

Supervisor Participant (PF)

Title	Dr
Forename(s)	Alastair
Surname	Noyce
Position	ST7 Neurology/ Clinical Senior Lec. Neurology

Research Support

Research Support Participant (CTF)

Title	Dr
Forename(s)	Ratna
Surname	Sohanpal
Position	Health Services Researcher

Administrative Authority or Finance Officer

Administrative Authority or FO Participant

Title	Mrs
Forename(s)	Coleen
Surname	Colechin
Position	Operations Manager

Signatories

Host Organisation - Heads of Department

Head of Department or Senior Manager

Title	Professor
Forename(s)	Fiona
Surname	Walter
Position	Prof of Primary Care Cancer Research

Pre-submission

Supervisors have access to all sections of the application form, once they have confirmed participation, and should work with the applicant to support the completion of the form.

Once the nominated 'Head of Department' signatory has confirmed their participation, they will be able to access the required 'Host Organisation Statement of Support' in the 'Training & Development and Research Support' section of the application form.

Once the 'Administrative Authority or Finance Officer' signatory has confirmed their participation, they will be able to access the 'Detailed Budget' section of the application form, which they must complete in conjunction with the applicant.

The 'Head of Department' and 'Administrative Authority or Finance Officer' can be working on their sections of the application form whilst you (the applicant) and supervisor(s) work on the rest of the application.

Signatories must confirm their participation in your application and complete their input in the relevant sections of the application before you will be able to press the submit button.

Signatories must also approve your application after you select the 'submit' option but BEFORE the application submission deadline.

The signatory approval from your 'Head of Department' will result in the application being fully submitted to the NIHR. All parties (applicant, participants and signatory) will be notified of this via an automated system-generated email.

NIHR will not accept any applications unless fully approved by your signatory prior to 1:00 pm on Thursday 14th March 2024.

8. Acknowledgement, Review and Submit

Conflict checks: Please declare any conflicts or potential conflicts of interest that you may have in undertaking this Fellowship, including any relevant, non-personal & commercial interest that could be perceived as a conflict of interest.
I declare that I have no conflicts or potential conflicts of interest regarding undertaking this fellowship.

By completing this form, the programme reserves the right to share, in confidence, details of your application with other parts of the NIHR and with the Department of Health and Social Care.

Agreement to Terms and Conditions:

I confirm that I have secured all necessary licences and ethical approvals in relation to the research and will abide by the terms of those licences and approvals in carrying out the research.

I confirm that I have read the NIHR Carbon Reduction Guidelines and, where possible, have taken steps to reduce the carbon emissions generated by this research.

I confirm that all material within this application, with the exception of sections that other participants are required to complete, is my work and I have taken steps to ensure that no parts of the application have been inappropriately plagiarised.

I undertake to conduct the research according to such guidelines for good research practice as the Host Organisation may from time to time lay down according to the NIHR Research Governance Framework.

In completing this, I declare that, to the best of my knowledge, the information provided in this application, is true, accurate and complete. I have read the Guidance Notes and agree to accept the process by which an application is assessed and agree to abide by the conditions under which an award may be granted.

☒Confirmed

Pre-submission

Appendices

1. Gantt Chart.pdf

Pre-submission

Appendix #1: Gantt Chart.pdf

Pre-submission

		Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26	Apr-26	May-26	Jun-26	Jul-26	Aug-26
NIHR Pre-Doctoral Fellowship																									
Research Assistant QMUL																									
MSc Social Research	Introduction to Qualitative Methods																								
	Introduction to Regression Analysis																								
	Systematic Review Design and Planning																								
	Advanced Qualitative Methods																								
	Advanced Quantitative Methods																								
	Ethnography																								
	Survey Design																								
	Research Engagement, Participation, and Impact																								
	Dissertation																								
Participatory Approaches in Public Health Specialisation																									
Mixed Methods in Health Research																									
Short Training Modules (academic & PPIE)																									
NIHR Academy Members Conference																									
NIHR SSCR Annual Conference																									
Movement Disorders Society International Congress																									
Meetings with Primary Supervisor																									
Meetings with Secondary Supervisor																									
Meetings with Research Supervisor																									
Monthly ELPD project Meetings																									
Monthly WIPH Meetings																									
Placement / Collaboration																									
Placement / Collaboration																									
Presenting and/or Publishing Research Project																									
NIHR Research Support Service (RSS) for Doctoral application																									
NIHR Doctoral Fellowship Preparation																									
NIHR Doctoral Fellowship Submission																									

Pre-submission